21

BERMUDA TRIANGLE

In the late hours of October 27, as Anatoly Dobrynin was busy in his Soviet embassy office completing his report to Moscow on the secret deal offered by Robert Kennedy, Gary Slaughter, a twenty-three-year-old Navy ensign, and his fellow seamen on the USS *Cony* finally set eyes on the prey they had been tracking for the past few days. From the waters of the Sargasso Sea, known to sailors throughout the world for its Bermuda Triangle (its other names include the Devil's Triangle and Hurricane Alley), a Soviet submarine was emerging.

The vessel was almost 90 meters (295 feet) long, painted black above the waterline and red below. Known to the Americans as Foxtrot, it was one of the most recent additions to the Soviet fleet of attack submarines in the Zulu class. Its turbines were powered by three diesel engines and three electric motors. It had ten torpedo tubes, six at the bow and four astern, and carried twenty-two torpedoes. With a regular crew of up to eighty officers, warrant officers, and seamen, it could dive more than 200 meters and stay